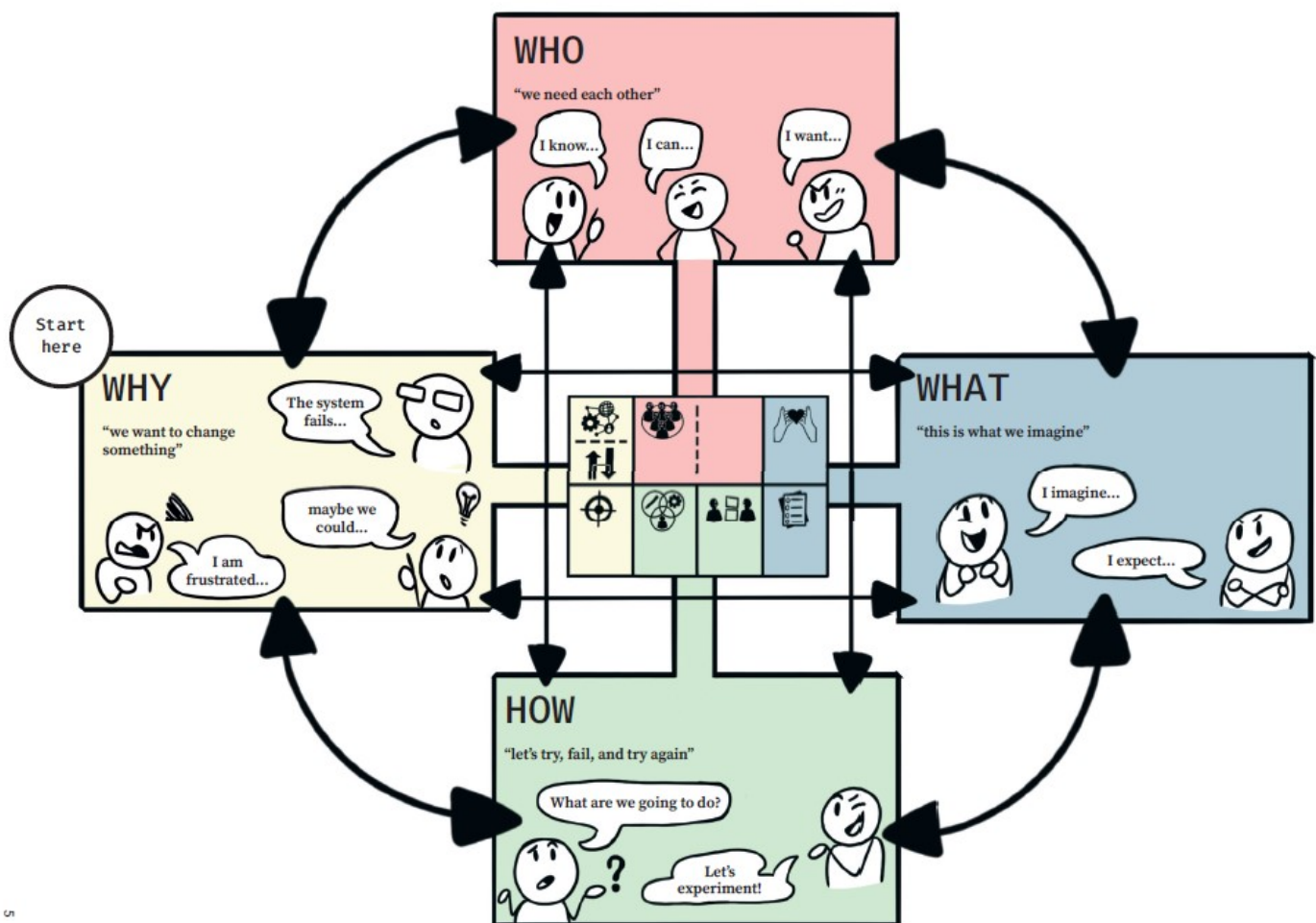


Dynamics and Roles in Different Phases of the Project^t

Be in control over the dynamics at every stage of your transdisciplinary project. Jointly explore and define the problem, and work effectively on solutions by collaborating strategically and sharing new insights with each other. Discover below how you can optimize your team process and disseminate results using the [Co-design Canvas](#) (Smeenck, 2020).



"If we want the ideas of involved citizens to have an impact, it can only be achieved through good collaboration with other parties."

Wina Smeenck, Professor of Societal Impact Design at Inholland University of Applied Sciences.

There are three phases in a transdisciplinary process:

1. **Exploring the Problem**
2. **Defining the Problem**
3. **Solving the Problem and Disseminating Results**

Exploring Each Other and the Problem

In phase 1, you explore the collaboration with your team members and the problem you are going to work on together (Oskam, 2023). You want to get to know each other and learn more about the issue at hand.

In short, you are looking to answer the following questions:

- Who are the problem owners?
- Who is needed to implement the solutions?
- Who will be affected by the potential solutions?

It's helpful to think broad. Consider including artists, animals, or nature in your theme exploration. Take enough time to get to know each other and clarify each other's expectations. A shared understanding of the problem is most important.

Getting to know your subject begins with identifying the different perspectives on the issue. This helps you understand the impact of the problem and define it more clearly.

Defining the Problem

Based on the insights from the previous phase, you now collectively formulate the problem definition. Make sure this results in a shared definition, not just from your own viewpoint or experiences. While brainstorming, focus on what your understandings have in common rather than the differences.

Solving the Problem and Disseminating Results

In phase 3, you work on solutions and new insights on the problem. Be aware that the results of your transdisciplinary project are not always easily measurable. In some cases, it is possible to deliver concrete results, while in others, the results may be less visible. Regularly reflect on the process and outcomes, and celebrate interim results together.

Practical Tool

The [Co-design Canvas](#) by Smeenk (2023) can assist you in the starting phase of the collaboration. It can help with consciously visualizing the collaboration between team members on forehand, the way you are going to involve stakeholders, structure and document the process, and the communication.